Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/james-l-bb215455 (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Training
Teaching
Instructor-led Training

Certifications

Business Development Foundations
Negotiation Skills
APMLOT Certificate
Level 7: Leadership and Management Award

Honors-Awards

Defense Meritorious Service Medal
The Bronze Star Medal

James L.

Director, Eastern & Southeast Europe at Shield AI | MSt University of Cambridge | Former Commando
Greece

Summary

A seasoned technical operations expert with extensive experience leading diverse teams in complex and high-risk operations, I believe in the power of autonomy and trusted Artificial Intelligence. I am committed to seizing strategic advantage through the rapid fielding of cutting-edge capabilities.

I relentlessly leverage technology to solve the most challenging problems and ensure that premier tech solutions reach the end users who need them the most. My dedication to excellence and maintaining technical advantage within the Department of Defense has been recognized with the awarding of the Bronze Star Medal and the Defense Meritorious Service Medal.

I thrive in dynamic, face-paced environments where I can work with highly motivated, mission-oriented people. If you're looking for a leader who combines technical expertise with a passion for innovation and operational excellence, or want to discuss game changing technology, let's connect.

Experience

Shield AI
1 year 10 months

Director, Eastern & Southeast Europe
May 2026 - Present (3 months)

Senior Manager, Eastern Europe
September 2025 - May 2026 (9 months)

Country Manager, Ukraine
October 2024 - September 2025 (1 year)

Joint Special Operations Command

Liaison Officer
January 2022 - November 2024 (2 years 11 months)
Washington, DC

Awarded:

The Bronze Star Medal

The United States Defense Meritorious Service Medal

Royal Military Academy Sandhurst
Platoon Commander
August 2020 - January 2022 (1 year 6 months)

Royal Marines
Royal Marines Officer
November 2013 - January 2022 (8 years 3 months)

USSOCOM
UK Liaison Officer
February 2021 - July 2021 (6 months)
Afghanistan

UK Ministry of Defence
Deputy Chief of Operations Kabul
November 2020 - February 2021 (4 months)
Kabul, Kabul Province, Afghanistan

Maestra
Business Development Manager APAC
January 2018 - November 2020 (2 years 11 months)
London, England, United Kingdom

Focusing on the growth of existing accounts, identifying opportunities and the aquisition
of new business in the APAC region. Developing a detailed business strategy for the
launch of Maestra-Group into the Asian market. Working closely with the CCO to drive
and maintain strong client relationships, through deep commercial understanding across
a myriad of industries. Receiving and implementing client briefs, building timelines with
project managers, and ensuring output meets high expectations of clients. Responsible

for setting and monitoring project KPIs—analysing results to optimise efficiencies and
ways-of-working.

Education

University of Cambridge

Master of Studies - MSt in Artificial Intelligence Ethics and Society · (2025 - 2027)

University of Oxford

Artificial Intelligence Programme · (2024 - 2024)

University of Cambridge

International Relations · (2023 - 2024)

Loughborough University

Bachelor of Arts (BA) · (2009 - 2012)

Chartered Management Institute

CMI Level 5 Diploma, Management and Leadership · (2015 - 2016)